

UNLIKELY ALLIES

Courtesy Nehru Memorial Museum and Library



MISPLACED FAITH: Jawaharlal Nehru with Chinese Premier Chou En-Lai (extreme left) and 14th Dalai Lama (third from left)

<< **REWIND**

A RAJKUMAR IS BORN

Bedara Kanappa was the launchpad for Karnataka's John Wayne and superstar Rajkumar. Directed by H.L.N. Simha, who gave the actor his present name, the film also saw the debut of G.V. Iyer, a



leading Kannada filmmaker known for his Sanskrit films, who wrote the story for the film. A partly mythological melodrama folk tale based on the legend of hunter Kanappa, the film ran for 100 days.

During a June visit to India, Chinese Premier Chou En-Lai and Jawaharlal Nehru signed a treaty popularly known as Panchsheel that outlined Five Principles of Peaceful Co-existence. In October, the prime minister visited Beijing where he attended a banquet in his honour with Chairman Mao. On his return, Nehru addressed a mammoth public meeting in Calcutta where he affirmed: "The people of China do not want war."

FIRST CUT

- Air Commodore P.C. Lal, group captain H. Moolgaonkar and wing commander Roshan Suri became the first Indians to break the super-

sonic speed barrier.

- Air Marshal S. Mukherji became the first Indian chief of air staff.
- The first high-rise in India—a 14-storeyed New Secretariat building in Calcutta came up.

<< DID YOU KNOW

13,000 housewives signed a petition claiming that films threatened the moral health of a country. The matter was then taken up by minister K.M. Munshi's wife Lilavati Munshi in the Rajya Sabha.